

EDUCATION

Harvard University , Cambridge, MA PhD, Engineering Sciences (Bio / Electrical) Advisor: Shriya S. Srinivasan, PhD	2025 –
Johns Hopkins University , Baltimore, MD MSE, Biomedical Engineering Thesis: Bridging Perception and Performance: Generating, Calibrating, & Evaluating Multimodal Sensory Stimuli Advisor: Jeremy D. Brown, PhD	GPA: 4.00 / 4.00 2023 – 2025
College of Engineering Pune , Pune, India BTech, Electronics and Telecommunication Engineering	GPA: 8.24 / 10.00 2019 – 2023

AWARDS & HONORS

Harvard SEAS Prize Fellowship (\$281,796 • 6-yr tuition, 2-yr stipend) • Harvard University	2025 –
National Defense Science & Engineering Graduate Fellowship (\$277,484) • Department of Defense	2025 –
GEM Associate Fellowship • National GEM Consortium	2025 –
Best Student Paper Finalist • International Conference on Rehabilitation Robotics (ICORR)	2025
National Institute on Aging Start-Up Challenge Finalist (\$10,000) • NIH	2025
Best Paper Award • International Conference on Biomedical Engineering Science and Technology, India	2023
Mitacs Globalink Research Award (\$9,915) • Dalhousie University, Canada	2022
Best Project Award • IEEE National Project Competition, India	2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE abbreviated; details at the end of CV

Harvard University • Biohybrid Organs and Neuroprosthetics Lab ↗ <i>Doctoral Researcher</i> • Advisor: Shriya S. Srinivasan, PhD • Ingestible Bioelectronics and Neural Interfacing for the GI Tract	Cambridge, MA 2025 –
Johns Hopkins University • Haptics and Medical Robotics Lab ↗ <i>Graduate Research Assistant</i> • Advisor: Jeremy D. Brown, PhD • Multimodal Visual-Haptic Neurorehabilitation for Post-Stroke Finger Dexterity • Pneumatactors: Soft Multimodal Haptic Interfaces	Baltimore, MD 2024 – 2025
Harvard University • Biohybrid Organs and Neuroprosthetics Lab ↗ <i>Research Fellow</i> • Advisor: Shriya S. Srinivasan, PhD • Peripheral Nerve Stimulation to Modulate Cancer Tumor Metastasis • Surgical Approach for Treating Stress Urinary Incontinence	Cambridge, MA Summer 2024
IIT Bombay • Human Motor Neurophysiology and Neuromodulation Lab ↗ <i>Research Intern</i> • Advisor: Nivethida Thirugnanasambandam, PhD • Quantifying Prospective Component of Sense of Agency using Machine Learning	Mumbai, India Spring, Summer 2023
College of Engineering Pune • Departments of Electronics, Applied Sciences ↗ <i>Undergraduate Researcher</i> • Advisor: Mahesh H. Shindikar, PhD • Deep Learning-Based MRI Skull Tissue Segmentation	Pune, India 2022 – 2023
Dalhousie University • Agricultural Mechanized Systems Group ↗ <i>Mitacs Globalink Research Intern</i> • Advisor: Travis J. Esau, PhD • Automating Harvesters to Reduce Operator Cognitive Load	Truro, Canada Summer 2022
Queliz Lifetech • Early Stage Medtech Startup ↗ <i>Research Intern, Electronics Subsystem</i>	Pune, India Summer 2021

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

- J5 **A. S. Pimpalkar** et al., “Pneumatactors: Soft 3D-printed interface for co-located transient and continuous tactile stimuli,” in preparation, 2025.
- J4 **A. S. Pimpalkar**, A. M. West, D. Rai, J. Xu, and J. D. Brown, “Evaluation of multimodal feedback to augment motor control in precision grip,” in preparation, 2025.
- J3 C. Harris, **A. S. Pimpalkar**, A. Aggarwal, J. Yang, X. Chen, S. Schmidgall, S. Rapuri, J. Greenstein, C. Overby-Taylor, and R. D. Stevens, “Risk prediction for non-cardiac surgery using the 12-lead electrocardiogram: An explainable deep learning approach,” *British Journal of Anesthesia* (in print), 2025. [Preprint ↗](#)
- J2 **A. S. Pimpalkar**, A. Slepian, and N. V. Thakor, “Vibrations at first contact encode object stiffness before grasp completion,” *IEEE Sensors Letters*, June 2025. doi: [10.1109/lens.2025.3584860](https://doi.org/10.1109/lens.2025.3584860) ↗
In Media: Featured in New Scientist Magazine. [Article ↗](#)
- J1 **A. S. Pimpalkar** and D. Niture, “Towards contactless elevators with tinyML using person detection and keyword spotting,” Jul 2024. [Best Project Award](#). [Preprint ↗](#)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS † presenter

FULL-LENGTH PAPERS

- C3 A. M. West †, **A. S. Pimpalkar**, J. Xu, and J. D. Brown, “SenseMatch: Smartphone-based cross-modal matching for accessible perceptual assessments,” *International Conference on Neural Engineering*, June 2025 (accepted).
- C2 **A. S. Pimpalkar** †, A. M. West, J. Xu, and J. D. Brown, “Optimizing cross-modal matching for multimodal motor rehabilitation,” *International Conference on Rehabilitation Robotics (ICORR / RehabWeek)*, May 2025. [Best Student Paper Award Finalist](#). *Podium presentation*. doi: [10.1109/icorr66766.2025.11063112](https://doi.org/10.1109/icorr66766.2025.11063112) ↗
- C1 **A. S. Pimpalkar** †, R. K. Patole, K. D. Kamble, and M. H. Shindikar, “Performance evaluation of vanilla, residual, and dense 2D U-Net architectures for skull stripping of augmented 3D T1-weighted MRI head scans,” *International Conference on Biomedical Engineering Science & Technology*, Feb 2023. [Best Paper Award](#). *Podium presentation*. doi: [10.1007/978-3-031-54547-4_11](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-54547-4_11) ↗

ABSTRACTS AND SHORT ARTICLES

- A7 **A. S. Pimpalkar** †, D. Rai, J. U. Bartels, J. Xu, and J. D. Brown, “Visual-haptic feedback enhances finger individuation in a virtual precision grip neurotraining task,” *Biomedical Engineering Society (BMES) Annual Meet*, Oct 2024. *Podium presentation*. [Abstract ↗](#)
- A6 H. Song † et al. [including **A. S. Pimpalkar**], “Towards visual function restoration through photoacoustic stimulation,” *Association for Research in Vision & Ophthalmology*, May 2024. *Podium presentation*. [Abstract ↗](#)
- A5 **A. S. Pimpalkar** †, P. Ameta †, A. Dalia, and J. D. Brown, “Pneumatactor arrays for high frequency vibrotactile feedback,” *IEEE Haptics Symposium*, Apr 2024. *Live demonstration, Work-in-Progress paper (2 presentations)*.
- A4 **A. S. Pimpalkar** †, P. Ameta †, A. Dalia †, and J. D. Brown, “Pneumatactor arrays for high frequency vibrotactile feedback,” *United States Senate AI Caucus: Robotics Demo Day*, Apr 2024. *Live demonstration*.
- A3 C. Harris †, **A. S. Pimpalkar**, A. Aggarwal, P. Yang, X. Chen, C. Overby-Taylor, J. Greenstein, and R. D. Stevens, “Surgical risk prediction using an explainable deep learning approach applied to pre-operative 12-lead electrocardiograms,” *Johns Hopkins Medicine & Engineering Research Retreat*, Feb 2024. *Poster presentation*. [Poster ↗](#)
- A2 **A. S. Pimpalkar** †, R. Patole, and N. Thirugnanasambandam, “Demonstrating the prospective component of sense of agency using machine learning,” *COEP ENTIC B-Tech Project Symposium*, May 2023. *Poster presentation*. [Poster ↗](#)
- A1 **A. S. Pimpalkar** †, R. Patole, K. Kamble, and M. Shindikar, “Evaluating U-Nets for skull stripping of augmented T1-weighted MRI scans,” *No Garland Neuroscience Conference*, Feb 2023. *Podium, poster presentation*. [Poster ↗](#)

TEACHING ENGAGEMENTS

Mechatronics • Johns Hopkins University

Spring 2024

Teaching Assistant to Jeremy D. Brown, PhD

- Solved a 3-year challenge in real-time location polling of autonomous air hockey robots using CV-based ArUco tag detection and ZigBee mesh networking ([open-source implementation ↗](#)). Led labs on building autonomous robots. Worked in a mentorship role in Spring 2025.

Principles of the Design of Biomedical Instrumentation • Johns Hopkins University Fall 2024
Teaching Assistant to Nitish V. Thakor, PhD

- Mentored labs on designing ECG, EMG, EEG circuits and projects including accessible gaming, wearables.

Haptic Interface Design for Human-Robot Interaction • Johns Hopkins University Fall 2024
Class Researcher with Jeremy D. Brown, PhD

- Helped pilot an online learning platform to provide self-paced lectures incorporating live instructor interaction.

INVITED TALKS

T1 Neural & Rehabilitation Engineering Course, Johns Hopkins University. (Nitish V. Thakor, PhD) [*Haptics: Neural Basis, Applications, Future Avenues*], Sep 2024.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

IEEE Haptics Symposium • Student Volunteer 2024
Canadian Society of Bioengineering Annual Meeting • Student Volunteer 2022

LEADERSHIP AND TEAMWORK

Johns Hopkins India Institute • Student Leader, Operations and Logistics 2024 – 2025

- Managed operations, logistics, sponsorships for university's first Hopkins India Conference, Washington DC.

Johns Hopkins Biomedical Engineering • Master's Program Representative 2024 – 2025
COEP Impressions Cultural Festival • Head of Events (2021), Volunteer 2019 – 2021

- Led the planning and execution of 28 annual events with 10k attendees, managing a ₹2m budget and coordinating with an overall team of 126 members to execute concerts, competitions, and international celebrity engagements.
- Built and led a team of 17, working with 2 co-heads to build a platform from the ground up, fostering opportunities for budding artists across India and uniting them under a shared vision. Placed an emphasis on the inclusion of unconventional art forms.

Rowing Team • COEP, Pune City • Competitive 1X, 2X, 4X Sculler 2020 – 2022

- Won multiple race events and an institutional award commending motivation and skill. Represented city at regional races.

COEP Mental Health & Wellness Center • Student Volunteer 2020 – 2022
COEP Data Science & AI Club • Research Lead (2020-21), Member 2020 – 2022

SKILLS AND CERTIFICATIONS

Medical Research	Human participant studies (non-invasive devices), rodent studies (invasive devices, mice/rats), human perception experiment design, IRB protocols
Electronics	Analog and digital circuit design, microcontroller programming (Arduino/Teensy/ESP/STM), high-speed and high-current PCB design (KiCAD/Altium), closed-loop control systems, DAQ design, FPGA, RF design, precision soldering (THT/SMT), mechatronic integration, communication protocols
Software Tools	Python, MATLAB, C/C++, data analysis, VR rendering, machine and deep learning, TinyML, TensorFlow (+lite/micro), computer vision, LaTeX
Design & Fab	CAD (Autodesk, Shapr3D), FDM 3D printing (rigid/flexible), SLA resin printing, silicone molding
Certifications (15 total)	Harvard Online • TinyML Certificate (3 courses), Python for Research, CS50 Web Development MIT Online • Aeronautics and Human Spaceflight Johns Hopkins Online • Human Subject Research, Neuroimaging, Neurohacking DeepLearning.AI • Deep Learning Specialization (5 courses) AICTE • Computer Science & Biology (faculty development program completed with permission)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE detailed

Harvard University • Biohybrid Organs and Neuroprosthetics Lab [↗](#)

Cambridge, MA

Doctoral Researcher • Advisor: Shriya S. Srinivasan, PhD

2025 –

Ingestible Bioelectronics and Neural Interfacing for the GI Tract

Designing ingestible bioelectronics for gut modulation and broader therapeutic use.

Johns Hopkins University • Haptics and Medical Robotics Lab [↗](#)

Baltimore, MD

Graduate Research Assistant • Advisor: Jeremy D. Brown, PhD

2024 – 2025

Multimodal Visual-Haptic Neurorehabilitation for Post-Stroke Finger Dexterity

Developed and evaluated a multimodal feedback framework for motor rehabilitation. Integrated cross-modal perceptual calibration to optimize sensory feedback delivery to individual thresholds. Implemented on ubiquitous devices to support smartphone-based rehabilitation outside the lab. *Publications:* [J4](#), [C2](#) (Best Student Paper Finalist at ICORR 2025), [C3](#), [A7](#)

Pneumatactors: Soft Multimodal Haptic Interfaces

Engineered “pneumatactors” – a novel pneumatic tactor haptic interface designed for co-located stimulation of fast and slow adapting mechanoreceptors, enhancing cognitive salience. 3D-printed with flexible TPE to match mechanical impedance of human skin for intuitive interaction. *Publications:* [J5](#), [A4](#), [A5](#)

Harvard University • Biohybrid Organs and Neuroprosthetics Lab [↗](#)

Cambridge, MA

Research Fellow • Advisor: Shriya S. Srinivasan, PhD

Summer 2024

Peripheral Nerve Stimulation to Modulate Cancer Tumor Metastasis

Developed non-invasive peripheral nerve stimulation strategies to modulate tumor growth and metastasis in murine models, revealing frequency-dependent effects on tumor innervation. Designed and conducted pilot studies on melanoma-bearing mice. Engineered miniaturized, RF-powered vagus nerve stimulators for freely moving rodents to study glioblastoma–nervous system interactions. Devices delivered monophasic pulses up to 1 kHz via custom PCB oscillators, enabling targeted parasympathetic modulation in vivo.

Surgical Approach for Treating Stress Urinary Incontinence

Innovated and tested a fully endogenous muscle graft-based surgical technique for treating stress urinary incontinence, featuring a 30-minute procedure with potential for fully laparoscopic implementation and superior efficacy compared to urethral devices. Conducted pilot surgeries on rat models, synchronizing bladder pressure, flow, and tension using a custom-designed PCB to assess and analyze urodynamic parameters.

IIT Bombay • Human Motor Neurophysiology and Neuromodulation Lab [↗](#)

Mumbai, India

Research Intern • Advisor: Nivethida Thirugnanasambandam, PhD

Spring, Summer 2023

Quantifying Prospective Component of Sense of Agency using Machine Learning

Characterized pre-movement EEG signatures underlying the Sense of Agency using a modified Libet clock task with probabilistic auditory feedback. Applied spectral, time-series, and machine learning analyses to identify spatiotemporal patterns predictive of intentional binding. Demonstrated distinct neural correlates in pre-SMA and centroparietal regions, supporting a prospective model of agency. *Publications:* [A2](#), Bachelor's Dissertation

College of Engineering Pune • Departments of Electronics, Applied Sciences [↗](#)

Pune, India

Undergraduate Researcher • Advisor: Mahesh H. Shindikar, PhD

2022 – 2023

Deep Learning-Based MRI Skull Tissue Segmentation

Developed and benchmarked vanilla, residual, and dense 2D U-Net architectures for skull stripping in neuroimaging, achieving 99.75% accuracy with a dense model optimized for feature reuse. Implemented data augmentation to improve generalizability across multi-scanner datasets. Demonstrated utility of open deep learning pipelines for replacing proprietary tools in MRI workflows. *Publications:* [C1](#) (Best Paper Award at ICBEST 2023), [A1](#)

Dalhousie University • Agricultural Mechanized Systems Group [↗](#)

Truro, Canada

Mitacs Globalink Research Intern • Advisor: Travis J. Esau, PhD

Summer 2022

Automating Harvesters to Reduce Operator Cognitive Load

Engineered a closed-loop control system to automate bin switching and dynamic harvester head height adjustment, reducing operator load. Used RGBD sensing for volumetric bin fill estimation ($\pm 10\%$ accuracy), and integrated crop height and GPS data to actuate harvester head in real time.

Queliz Lifetech • Early Stage Medtech Startup [↗](#)

Research Intern, Electronics Subsystem

Pune, India
Summer 2021

Point-of-Care Device for Finger Dexterity Rehabilitation in Acute Burn Patients

Designed an affordable, portable rehabilitation device to restore MCP, DIP, and PIP joint mobility in burn patients. Developed a precision actuation system with adaptive feedback to enable customized therapy in low-resource clinical settings.